



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Library/Museum Information Literacy Handbook Manual

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NATIONAL POLICE COLLEGE OF JAMAICA

LIBRARY/MUSEUM



INFORMATION LITERACY HANDBOOK 2025

CONTENTS

Introduction.....	1
What is Information Literacy	2
Guidance for Teachers/Instructors	3-4
Guidance for Learners/Students	5-7
The Framework for Information Literacy Education	8-9
Information Literacy Plan for the Library	10
Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at Level 1	11-12
Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at Level 2	13-15
Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at Level 3	16-18
Information Literacy Resources	19
Conclusion	20
References.....	21

INTRODUCTION

The term information literacy was first defined in 1974 by Paul Zurkowski, the then president of the United States Information Industry Association when he made a proposal to the National Commission on Libraries and Information Science (NCLIS). (Melangeinfo, 2021). His proposal was on the need for training people who will possess the techniques and skills for utilising the wide range of information tools as well as their primary sources in moulding information solutions to their problems. Since then, a number of international organizations have defined the term varyingly but all driving down the same point. Take a view of such definitions below.

Information is seen as processed data that is capable of answering users query. It is “fuel for development” and life wire of societies because it is vital to the activities of government and private individuals as they strive towards growth. (Igwe, 1986). Information is vital for political, economic, social and technological development of the world. The students are expected to know how to navigate through large quantity of information that is available in libraries, internet and other sources to obtain the right data or information needed for research, assignments and critical thinking.

The Association of College and Research Libraries Information Competency for higher education (2000) define information literacy as “a set of characteristics that transform an ordinary student, helps people to obtain skills not just for academic programmes as a student but for lifelong learning.” (ALA, p. 2) Information literacy is therefore a prerequisite for effective use of information.

Objectives

The objectives of this booklet is to conceptualize guidelines for the creation of information literacy (IL) programs in the National Police College of Jamaica. It

provides information to frame the IL efforts of educators, librarians and information facilitators.

It gives examples of exercises that can be given to students to see how they handle information and so be trained to use IL in their everyday life. It also gives the facilitator an idea of how to assess students on their information literacy knowledge.

What is Information Literacy

Information literacy is knowing when and why information is needed, where to find it and how to evaluate, use and communicate it in the right manner.

The National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) believes in the delivery and development of learning. The aim is to train the minds of this institution to know when, why, where and how to find and use information and to communicate it effectively. Information Literacy is intended to provide a clear and integrated development structure for librarians, teachers, lectures and trainers to support students in their learning experiences. Information literacy is to support the curriculum and helps to develop independent learning skills such as the proper use of dictionary skills, how to find information whether in history or science among other subject areas online or otherwise and the correct way to write.

Information literacy is also an element of digital inclusion such as the development of critical evaluation skills which protects the user when dealing with information online. The involvement of information literacy in subject based learning in both formal and informal settings are beneficial to the learner and practitioners in the library and classroom.

In an institution such as NPCJ, students will be completing other learning to which the information literacy skills learnt can be applied. The main courses should be used to determine the tasks used to achieve the information literacy unit. This may be project work that would warrant research as part of the learning core and teaching staff will take notice in their assessment how well their students have incorporated information literacy

into completing their projects.

Guidance for Teachers/Instructors

Some Teaching Points for Consideration:

1. It is suggested that library searches should be included at each level and that library staff be aware of the curriculum so that they will be cognizant of the information literacy requirements to support the student.
2. The curriculum should be strengthened to include thinking, Boolean search and other search strategies to enable users to make effective use of library resources
3. Teachers should be aware that information literacy skills is about problem solving and is therefore a more theoretical, research based skill at the higher level and practical at the lower level.
4. It must be noted that although projects should meet the assessment criteria, the project maybe an on-going process requiring additional tasks to fully meet the information literacy.
5. Ensure students are aware of plagiarism, copyright and how to use information appropriately in their evidence for assessment in their main subject areas such as the stipulated APA and Chicago style of writing which is used at NPCJ. (See APA Handbook online)
6. Students need to be given a certain amount of hours each week to improve their information literacy skills whether it be in completing an assignment that requires using writing skills information, which can be derived at the library to learn the different style of writing.
7. The teaching of utilization of electronic information sources should also be enhanced applying ICT in the teaching and learning of information literacy.
8. There is need for guided tours, flipped instructions, video conferencing, advanced literature search, use of interactive boards and other computer aided

programmes to enable the students to source information with minimal help in the globalized world.

9. Teachers need to know that a part of assessing their students is by administering case studies, by observation, written questions and answers/tests/exams, oral questions and answers, written assignment, role play/simulation, group discussions, surveys and journal keeping to ascertain students' knowledge of plagiarism and information literacy on a whole.
10. Staff who are teaching need to determine the most appropriate level of study for the student that is, their understanding of information literacy and communication skills. This will enable the teacher to know whether or not to give the student a simple research paper to do or to write a thesis. (See Level Charts)
11. There will be the need for training the trainers' workshops regularly to acquaint lecturers/librarians with recent developments in information literacy to enable them to impart quality knowledge to the students.

Guidance for Learners/Students

What is information Literacy

Information literacy is knowing when and why information is needed, where to find it and how to evaluate, use and communicate it in the right manner.

1. The Importance of Information Literacy

Students will need to note that in all areas of their lives they will need the skills and understanding to access relevant information to meet the needs of work, learning and even in their leisure time. With so much informational resources it is sometimes difficult to know how best to access the information one needs and to address its currency, accuracy and validity. Undertaking learning in information literacy will address this situation.

2. What the student will get out knowing about Information Literacy

Completing Information Literacy units, will help the student with their other studies and provide them with valuable life skills useful whenever they are seeking information.

A student in the future by simply asking for directions to somewhere, how to purchase articles on-line or just how to find general information, entails using information wisely. Students will also be better able to sell on-line and use social media better.

3. How Information Literacy can be linked to students studies

The curriculum should be set up so that students can complete their information literacy in association with the library and the units can be completed individually or be integrated into any studies they are taking.

4. The Right level at which the student should be learning

If student are already undertaking any other learning, the level at which they are doing that, will give them guidance on their level of Information Literacy study. If they are not undertaking any other learning, the delivery staff/teacher will work with the student to determine the most appropriate level in their area of interest.

5. How does the Student get recognition for the learning

Students will be awarded credit as decided by the Institution for the Information Literacy unit or units they have completed and that will be linked to the record of other learning achievements.

6. How can the student progress their learning

After students have completed their Information Literacy unit, they can progress to a higher level unit or they can use the skills acquired to take into another area of learning. Guidance will be given by the teacher.

With Information Literacy knowledge students should be able to:

The Student will be able to:	The Student can:
Recognize a range of information sources	- Identify people or organizations from whom information can be derived - Identify different types of written information
Recognize the preparation necessary when gathering information for a specific project	-State the facts already known about the chosen subject - Outline the information needed - State the checks to be made to ensure that information is suitable -Identify where the most relevant information might be found from a range of options. -Put together questions to use to obtain information orally -Identify the key words to look for in written sources
Judge value of information	-Ask questions to obtain information -Listen for and identify main points of an answer -Identify key information from simple texts -Check that information meets the requirements.
Know how to identify information	-State information found and how it is to be used, recording key details -Present the information in the most appropriate way for the audience and purpose

All these skills involve a deeper understanding of how and where to find information, the ability to judge whether that information is meaningful, and ultimately, how best that information can be incorporated to address the problem or issue at hand. A student that possesses the skills will as well become aware of the way in which information systems work, in connection to information need versus the relevant sources and channels required to satisfy the need.

The Framework for Information Literacy Education

It is important that an academic institution have a good teaching plan outline as what to teach students as information literacy, the objective being to introduce to students the need and importance of the study.

1. **The Perception of Information:** Teachers should explain and define to the student the board and scholarly meanings of the term “information”, to describe to students the various formats of information such as print and electronic and to narrate to them the various sources/channel/carriers of scholarly information in general.
2. **Information Access Tools:** Outline to students the various resources and/or tools that direct users to academic information, with particular reference to the institutions library.
3. **Use of Academic Information:** Students are to be taught how academic libraries function, its departments, holdings and how to utilise the library in general. Strategies to search for information, the objective being to educate students on how to search for online information resources and database resources as subscribed by the institution and are freely available on the internet.
4. **Evaluation of Information:** The objective here is to teach students the various features or characteristics of good and reliable information materials that contain credible, peer-review and certified information that can be depended on for research and learning.
5. **Information Description and Citation:** Students are to be taught the importance of citation and referencing as features of academic writings. They are to be exposed to the various styles and formats of citation and are to be warned against plagiarism. To stress that the remedy to plagiarism is proper citation and referencing.
6. **Legal issues in the use of information:** Students should be taught the definition of

copyright, list the various ways to not infringe on it and outline the punishments attached to its infringement.

A summarized Teaching Model for Information Literacy Education

- Knowledge Sharing in the Digital Environment
- Understanding Study Skills, information
- Information Literacy Skills and the Research
- Legal Issues in the use of information
- Ethical Issues in Using Information Sources
- Knowledge of Critical Thinking, Evaluation of...
- Access and Use of Academic Library(s)
- Access and Use of Free-Based Online Information...
- Information Search Strategies
- Information Access Tools
- Sources of Information
- The Concept and Characteristics of Information
- Introduction to Information Literacy Education

Information Literacy Levels Plan

This Plan is formulated around three levels of contact with the students. Each level addressing ascending skills. The goal of the plan is to ensure that all students graduating from NPCJ are able to identify and use information tools appropriately.

Recruits	Level One: Orientation
	This level seeks to aid students in their transition from high school to college, or other institutions where they may not be familiar with Information Literacy at a formal level. Instruction at this level seeks to: • Reduce anxiety toward academic libraries and college-level research. • Create awareness of key services and resources available through the library (reference desk, multimedia support, tutoring, etc.). • Use information ethically (plagiarism, style manuals). Students may also be introduced to the Basic Skills listed below.
	Level Two: Basic Skills
Course Students	This level focuses on basic information skills and resources. Instruction at this level teaches students to: • Identify information needs and retrieve relevant information. • Analyze topic statements and formulate search strategies. • Search for and retrieve books and scholarly articles. • Evaluate information found on the public web. • Use information ethically (plagiarism, style manuals). Students may also be introduced to the basic tools of their discipline.
	Level Three: Discipline-Specific Skills

Level three instruction builds on Level II skills by applying them within the context of the students' major field of study. Instruction at this level focuses on:

- Increasing student awareness and use of resources within their discipline
- Advanced searching skills.
- Using bibliographic management utilities (Ref. works).
- Defining the publication cycle of their discipline.
- Emphasizing critical evaluation of all sources.

Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at L1

At each level there will be assessment guidance that suggests appropriate topics or tasks that are used to provide evidence for assessment to achieve Information Literacy Skills. Every effort should be made to use topics or tasks that are most relevant to the learner and their wider study, learning or interests.

The following example will not be exhaustive or be designed to fully meet the assessment criteria but is to be a source of guidance for delivery staff/teacher.

The format of the assessment guidance for each level will be:

- ✚ Information Sources
- ✚ Preparing and Planning
- ✚ Gathering and Assessing Information
- ✚ Presenting Information

And against each stage will be examples of how meeting the assessment criteria might be approached.

Teaching input is likely to be necessary for learners to be able to carry out the tasks described in the

example scenario effectively. Additional tasks should be used to practice and develop the skills needed to meet the assessment criteria and this evidence can be presented in a practice portfolio.

Teaching points for this level include:

- ✚ Use of a search engine
- ✚ Recognising and spelling key words
- ✚ Numeracy functions / calculations (time and money)
- ✚ Simple indexing
- ✚ Accurate recording of information
- ✚ Searching text

Example Scenario:

The learner is planning a journey from A to B and back to A by one means of transport (Knutsford Express bus) on a specific day, and destination with the aim of visiting a venue such as a museum, gallery etc that opens at 10.00am and is about 5 minutes disembarkation from the venue. The task is to identify the departure time taking account of the opening time of the venue, the length of the journey, time to reach the venue, time spent at the venue and the return journey time. The learner will have to identify the cost of the journey, the intermediate stops and any changes, how to book a seat and what facilities are available on the journey (refreshments, toilets, WIFI etc) This information will be presented to someone making the journey for the specified purpose of visiting the venue. One possible approach to recording the learning and providing assessment evidence would be to use the four following documents.

1. Information Sources
2. Preparing and Planning
3. Gathering and Assessing Information
4. Presenting the Information

Potential skills to look for in task given:

- Reading bus timetables

- Reading information / guidance about Knutsford Express
- Money - cost of travel
- Extract required details from text
- Obtain any other specific information through detailed reading and tables
- Present information using sequencing, formal written style and accuracy

Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at Level 2

This assessment guidance suggests appropriate topics or tasks that may be used to provide evidence for assessment to achieve Information Literacy Skills unit at Level 2. At this level it is to be noted that every effort should be made to use topics or tasks that are most relevant to the learner and their wider study, learning or interests. The format for the example demonstrates how the learner might record their evidence.

The example is defined as a scenario and has been worked through for each learning outcome and indicates how the assessment criteria might be met. However, the example is not exhaustive and is not designed to fully meet all assessment criteria but to be a source of guidance for delivery staff/teacher.

For some learners, this example would be suitable for use with units relating to project work. The format of the assessment guidance for each level will set out the stages of learning as:

1. Information Sources
2. Preparing and Planning
3. Gathering and Assessing Information
4. Presenting the Information

Teaching input may be necessary for learners to be able to carry out the tasks described in the example scenario effectively. Additional tasks should be used to practise and develop the skills needed to meet the assessment criteria and this evidence can be presented in the evidence portfolio.

Example Scenario:

The learner is required to plan an overnight trip from A (Westmoreland) to B (Kingston) and back again the following day. The trip for a single person includes:

- Attending a special opening at theatre X which starts at 7.30pm and is already booked
- Overnight stay, (bed and breakfast) in a comfortable hotel close to the theatre
- Time to check in to the hotel and change clothes before the show
- Visiting a landmark/venue for which the city is famous on the second day, before returning home.

The task is to:

- Identify the route, departure and arrival times for both outward and return journeys using one mode of transport (taxi or bus).
- Identify the total cost of the journey; the intermediate stops and any changes; how to obtain tickets and book a seat; the facilities available on the selected transport.
- Identify how to find and book a suitable hotel, the facilities and services available at the accommodation and costs.
- Suggest famous sights or venues including opening times and costs where relevant.
- prepare an information pack so that the individual who intends to make the specified trip has a detailed itinerary that is easy to follow.

Teaching points for this level include:

- ✚ Library search skills
- ✚ Using indexes
- ✚ Using multiple key words within search engines
- ✚ Accessing and using maps
- ✚ Using DVDs; data files and graphical material
- ✚ Recording references and quotes
- ✚ Outlining/webbing methods to sort information
- ✚ Plagiarism and copyright

Potential skills to look for in task given:

- Spelling, grammar, punctuation
- Using formal and informal written styles
- Sequencing a presentation
- Using images/models in a presentation
- Understanding and extracting information from tables
- Construct tables with correct labelling

Information Sources:

Describe how to access the source

- By print/online (timetables, brochures, travel guides/books, map
- Go to the railway/bus station
- Go to the Tourist Information
- Office and /or Travel Agency
- Go to the library

Assessment Guidance for Information Literacy at Level 3

This assessment guidance suggests appropriate topics or tasks that may be used to provide evidence for assessment to achieve Information Literacy Skills at Level 3. Below is an example and every effort should be made to use topics or tasks that are most relevant to the learner and their wider study, learning or interests. The format for the example demonstrates how the learner might demonstrate or record their evidence.

The example is defined as a scenario and has been worked through for each learning outcome of the unit and indicates how the assessment criteria might be met. However, the example is not exhaustive and is not designed to fully meet all assessment criteria but to be a source of guidance for delivery staff. It is anticipated that tutors will use a range of tasks and exercises to develop the necessary skills to ensure that the range and scope is matched to the requirements. At level 3 projects should be given and the tutor will need to produce a mapping to show how the requirements are to be met.

The format of the assessment guidance for each level will set out the stages of learning as:

1. Information Sources
2. Preparing and Planning
3. Gathering and Assessing Information
4. Presenting the Information

These stages map to the four learning outcomes. Teaching input may be necessary for learners to be able to carry out the tasks described in the example scenario effectively. Additional tasks should be used to practice and develop the skills needed to meet the assessment criteria and this evidence can be presented in the evidence portfolio.

Example Scenario:

“Getting serious about recycling” <https://jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20180705/earth-today-getting-serious-about-recycling>, July 4, 2018. This article reports the three million tonnes of waste per year which means there are more waste than people on the island. Making reference to this headline, the learner has been asked to prepare a proposed briefing on ways of recycling in Jamaica. This is to be presented to the National Environment and Planning Agency (NEPA)

It is important that the audience are made aware of:

- ✚ the part that recycling and waste management plays in the overall ‘Going Green’ agenda
- ✚ what is meant by municipal waste and how it is measured
- ✚ the Jamaican Government’s strategy document on waste management
- ✚ how the island is currently performing and the trends over time (last 5 years)
- ✚ what the local council is already doing and what else could be done

This scenario could easily be adapted to focus on any aspect of sustainable development.

Teaching points for this level include:

- ✚ Using a variety of information sources in a range of formats and mediums
- ✚ Using multiple search criteria and combinations of key words within search engines
- ✚ Quality indicators for internet resource evaluation
- ✚ Using databases, tables and graphical material
- ✚ How to cite internet resources and text references
- ✚ Using outlining/webbing methods to sort information
- ✚ Understanding plagiarism and copyright

Potential skills to look for in task given:

- Spelling, grammar and punctuation
- Reading, understanding and using specialist vocabulary
- Structuring a talk/presentation
- Giving a talk/presentation, using appropriate style and tone

- Understanding and responding to spoken language
- Responding constructively using active listening techniques
- Selecting and exploring a range of documents and bringing together relevant information
- Collecting relevant numerical data and information
- Selecting different ways to present charts/graphs and tables/diagrams to an audience
- Speak clearly to be heard and understood using appropriate clarity, speed and phrasing
- Extract detail from explanations, instructions and narratives
- Identify the main points and ideas in documents
- Obtain specific information through detailed reading

Some Information Literacy Resources

Ideas Exchange

Link: <http://library.queensu.ca/wiki/elearning/doku.php>

Description: A Wiki designed to share ideas and e-learning tools for information literacy.

Classroom Instruction in Facebook

Link: <https://www.facebook.com/group.php?gid=2416166855>

Description: Facebook group devoted to libraries that use Facebook to complement and/or supplement formal library class instruction sessions. A particular focus of the group is the use of Facebook in association with basic library skills.

JISC media digital, Internet for image searching

Link: <http://www.vtstutorials.ac.uk/tutorial/image searching/>

Description: Free online tutorial on finding digital copyright cleared digital images which are available free; facilitating quick, hassle-free access to a vast range of online photographs and other visual resources.

Conclusion

The role of information literacy in improving academic performance and contribution to national development and lifelong learning cannot be overemphasized. Libraries in the developing countries should be equipped with electronic gadgets that will facilitate teaching and learning of information literacy in this era of globalization. This booklet merely provides a structure for development that should strengthen and direct information literacy provision so that it may better serve the interest of the learner.

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